

Job Search Kit

Cover letters, target companies, tracker, daily playbook,
and 25 live jobs ready to apply to.

Faris Hamdan

Built 2026-05-27 to support the launch of the Plotzy.co job search.

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Overview

Job Search Kit — Faris Hamdan

Everything you need to land a remote full-stack engineering job in 2 to 3 months. Four files. Read them in order.

The files

1. [01_COVER_LETTERS.md](#) — three cover letter variants (AI, SaaS startup, established company) plus a follow-up template and a hook bank.
2. [02_TARGET_COMPANIES.md](#) — 60+ companies and 13 job boards sorted by realistic chance of a reply, with the cover letter variant to use for each.
3. [03_TRACKER.md](#) — application tracker template plus the rules for follow-ups and weekly review.
4. [04_DAILY_PLAYBOOK.md](#) — the exact routine: week one setup, week two onwards steady state, how to apply in 90 seconds, how to prep for the first call, realistic timeline.

The CV

The PDF to attach to every application:

[docs/Faris_Hamdan_CV.pdf](#)

Download URL anywhere:

```
https://github.com/faresadel07/plotzy1/raw/master/docs/Faris_Hamdan_CV.pdf
```

Today's first step

Open [04_DAILY_PLAYBOOK.md](#) and start at "Day 1 (today)".

90 minutes. Four accounts. Five applications. Done.

Realistic expectations

Time	Applications	Offers
End of week 1	40 to 60	0
End of week 4	160 to 200	0 to 1
End of week 8	350 to 400	2 to 5

The single rule

25 applications per week. Every week. Without exception.

Five days, five applications a day. Or two big days a week of twelve and thirteen. Whichever fits your energy. The number is the number.

Chapter 1, Cover Letters

Cover Letters Kit — Faris Hamdan

Three battle-tested cover letter variants for different job types. Each is short (under 220 words), highlights Plotzy as proof of capability, and ends with a clear ask. Pick the variant by company type, change three or four words to match the role, paste, send.

The three variants:

1. **AI Variant** — for jobs that mention LLMs, AI integration, GPT, Claude, OpenAI, RAG, agents, or "AI engineer".
2. **SaaS Startup Variant** — for jobs at startups under 200 people that want a generalist full-stack developer.
3. **Established Company Variant** — for jobs at companies of 200+ that list specific stack requirements and structured processes.

Personal data baked in:

- Name: Faris Hamdan
- Location: Zarqa, Jordan (open to remote and relocation)
- Tech: React + TypeScript + Node.js + PostgreSQL + AI integration
- Live demo: <https://plotzy.co>
- Repo: <https://github.com/faresadel07/plotzy1>
- LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/fares-hamdan-428882305>
- Email: faresadelqd@gmail.com

How to use each variant:

1. Open the file.
2. Copy the entire variant.
3. Replace `{COMPANY}` with the company name.
4. Replace `{ROLE}` with the exact role title in the job posting.
5. Replace `{HOOK}` with one sentence about why this specific company.
6. Send.

Variant A — AI Variant

Use when the job mentions: AI, LLM, GPT, Claude, OpenAI, AI engineer, agents, RAG, prompt engineering, AI integration, ML, machine learning.

Subject: Full-Stack Engineer with shipped AI product. Plotzy.co.

Hi {COMPANY} team,

I am applying for the {ROLE} position. I am a full-stack developer who shipped a production AI product solo: Plotzy.co, a bilingual Arabic and English writing platform that integrates ten distinct AI features (writing assistant, audiobook narration, marketplace analyses, cover prompts, manuscript proposal generator, and more) on top of an OpenAI-compatible SDK pointed at Groq's Llama 3.3 70B for cost.

What I built and why it is relevant to {COMPANY}: a centralised `handleAiError` helper that unpacks provider error shapes (status, code, type, message) and surfaces real reasons to admin users so production debugging does not require log access. A two-attempt fallback strategy for rate-limited prompts. Self-hosted Piper TTS inside the Docker container so audiobook narration runs at zero per-minute cost. Prompt engineering tuned for Arabic and English in parallel.

The full repo is open source: <https://github.com/faresadel07/plotzy1> (100K+ lines of TypeScript, 257 REST endpoints, 43 pages, 30+ tables). Live demo: <https://plotzy.co>.

{HOOK}

Available to start immediately. Open to remote work and relocation.

Faris Hamdan
faresadelqd@gmail.com
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/fares-hamdan-428882305>

Variant B — SaaS Startup Variant

Use when the job is at a startup under 200 people and lists a generalist full-stack role (React + Node + Postgres or similar).

Subject: Full-Stack Engineer who shipped a full SaaS solo. Plotzy.co.

Hi {COMPANY} team,

I am applying for the {ROLE} position. I built and shipped Plotzy.co solo as my graduation project: a production SaaS writing platform with chapter editor, AI assistant, audiobook studio, AI marketplace, publishing flow, community library, admin panel, and a six-module writing course with verifiable certificates. End to end. Schema, backend, frontend, AI prompts, design, DevOps, docs.

What I think will matter to {COMPANY}: I made every technical decision myself, including the ones I had to revisit later. I migrated the database from Neon to Supabase mid-project to escape a free-tier ceiling, swapped OpenAI direct for Groq to cut spend by 90%, replaced Edge TTS with self-hosted Piper, and pivoted the entire pricing model from tiered SaaS to donation-funded without rewriting the schema. I ship under real constraints.

Stack: React 18 + TypeScript + Tailwind + Radix UI on the frontend, Express + Drizzle + PostgreSQL on the backend, Docker on Railway, Vercel on the edge.

Live demo: <https://plotzy.co>

Open source: <https://github.com/faresadel07/plotzy1>

{HOOK}

Available immediately. Open to remote work and relocation.

Faris Hamdan

faresadelqd@gmail.com

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/fares-hamdan-428882305>

Variant C — Established Company Variant

Use when the job is at a company of 200+ people with structured processes and explicit stack requirements.

Subject: Full-Stack Application – {ROLE}.

Dear {COMPANY} Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the {ROLE} position. I am a final-year Business Information Technology student at the Hashemite University in Jordan, and the founder and sole engineer behind Plotzy.co, a production bilingual writing SaaS now serving Arabic and English writers globally.

The Plotzy build covers every layer of a modern web application and maps directly to the responsibilities in your job posting:

- Frontend: React 18, TypeScript, Tailwind, Radix UI, TanStack React Query, React Hook Form, Zod, TipTap, Framer Motion, GSAP, Three.js, PWA via Workbox.
- Backend: Express + TypeScript, Drizzle ORM, PostgreSQL on Supabase, Passport.js (Google + Apple OAuth + email), bcrypt, connect-pg-simple sessions, three-layer rate limiting.
- AI and Audio: OpenAI SDK targeting Groq, ten distinct AI features, Piper TTS self-hosted in Docker for unlimited audiobook narration.
- Payments and Email: PayPal Smart Buttons with the Orders API and idempotent captures, Resend transactional email with bilingual templates.
- DevOps: Vercel for the frontend, Railway with a custom multi-stage Dockerfile for the backend, Supabase Postgres, pnpm workspaces monorepo.

Live demo: <https://plotzy.co>

Open source: <https://github.com/faresadel07/plotzy1>

{HOOK}

I am available to start immediately, open to working in your time zone, and willing to relocate.

Thank you for considering my application.

Faris Hamdan

faresadelqd@gmail.com

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/fares-hamdan-428882305>

The {HOOK} bank — one-liners to slot in

For the {HOOK} placeholder, pick one of these one-liners that fits the company, OR write a fresh one. The goal is to prove you actually read their site or job post, not to flatter them.

Generic hooks (safe defaults when you do not know the company):

- I am drawn to teams that ship fast and trust their engineers to own decisions end to end, and the role description suggests {COMPANY} is one of them.
- The {ROLE} responsibilities map closely to what I have already shipped alone on Plotzy, and I would like to do that kind of work as part of a team that already moves at speed.

Company-specific hook templates (replace the bracketed parts):

- I have been [using / following / reading the changelog of] {COMPANY} for [time period] and I appreciate that you [specific decision you noticed: shipped X, open-sourced Y, wrote about Z].
- I noticed {COMPANY} uses [specific tech they mentioned] in your stack; I have shipped that on Plotzy and would enjoy working on it inside a larger codebase.
- Your post mentions [specific responsibility]; I implemented exactly that on Plotzy in [specific subsystem]. Happy to walk through the decision tree on a call.

For AI companies specifically:

- I have read your [docs / blog post about X] and the way {COMPANY} thinks about [specific concept] mirrors how I built [related subsystem in Plotzy]. I would like to learn more by joining you.

For dev tool companies (Vercel, Supabase, Resend, etc.):

- I am already a user of {COMPANY} in production on Plotzy. Joining the team that ships the product I rely on every day would be the obvious next step.

The follow-up message

If you do not hear back in 5 business days, send this short follow-up. Keep it to four sentences max.

Hi {COMPANY} team,

Following up on my application for the {ROLE} role last week. I remain interested and available immediately. If a different role on the team might be a better fit, I am happy to pivot.

Live demo: <https://plotzy.co>

Open source: <https://github.com/faresadel07/plotzy1>

Faris Hamdan

Three rules for the email itself

1. **Subject line.** The exact subject I wrote in each variant is already tuned. Do not change it unless the job posting requires a specific reference number, in which case prepend it: `Ref ABC-1234 | Full-Stack Engineer...`
2. **Attachments.** Always attach the PDF at `docs/Faris_Hamdan_CV.pdf`. Never paste the CV into the body.
3. **One link in the body.** If the platform allows only one URL in the body, use <https://plotzy.co>. The GitHub link is in the CV anyway.

House style for every cover letter you send from here on

- No em-dashes, no en-dashes, no emojis.
- Short paragraphs (no more than four lines each).
- Direct subject lines.
- Always close with availability and openness to relocation.

- Always mention Plotzy.co and the GitHub repo within the first three sentences.

Chapter 2, Target Companies

Target Companies and Job Boards — Faris Hamdan

A prioritised list of where to apply, ordered by realistic chance of a reply + good pay. Every company here is known to hire engineers internationally, including from MENA, without requiring relocation.

Apply in order. Tier 1 first (the gold), Tier 2 next, Tier 3 in parallel as fillers. Track every application in [03_TRACKER.md](#).

TIER 1 — Direct applications to remote-first companies

These companies are famous for global remote hiring, transparent salaries, and engineering-led cultures. Apply through their careers pages, not LinkedIn (their careers pages give better signal).

Pure remote, global, top tier

Company	Careers URL	Why apply	Variant to use
GitLab	about.gitlab.com/jobs	100% remote since day one, hires globally, transparent salary	C
Automattic	automattic.com/work-with-us	WordPress.com, fully distributed, hires from MENA	C
Doist	doist.com/careers	Maker of Todoist, async-first, hires globally	B
Toggl	toggl.com/jobs	Async-first, hires from MENA, ships fast	B
Buffer	buffer.com/journey/careers	Pay transparency, remote since 2015	B
Zapier	zapier.com/jobs	One of the largest remote-first SaaS companies	B
DuckDuckGo	duckduckgo.com/hiring	Remote-first, mission-driven	C
Canonical (Ubuntu)	canonical.com/careers	Global remote, hires juniors with strong projects	C
Mozilla	mozilla.org/careers	Remote-friendly, mission-aligned with bilingual Plotzy	C
HashiCorp	hashicorp.com/jobs	Remote-friendly, AI infra adjacent	C

Dev tools and developer-platform companies

Company	Careers URL	Why apply	Variant
Supabase	supabase.com/careers	You already use them on Plotzy. Direct fit.	B
Vercel	vercel.com/careers	You already deploy on them. Mention this.	B
Resend	resend.com/careers	You use them for transactional email.	B
Stripe	stripe.com/jobs	Selective but hires globally. Highlight payments on Plotzy.	C
PostHog	posthog.com/careers	Open source, transparent, hires globally	B
Cloudflare	cloudflare.com/careers	Remote-friendly, strong eng culture	C
Linear	linear.app/careers	Strong product, remote-friendly, small team	B
Postman	postman.com/careers	API tooling, hires globally	C
Plaid	plaid.com/careers	Fintech, US but hires some remote	C
Hugging Face	huggingface.co/jobs	AI focus, remote-friendly	A

AI-focused companies (use Variant A)

Company	Careers URL	Why apply	Variant
Anthropic	anthropic.com/careers	Hard to get into, worth one shot	A
Replit	replit.com/careers	Online IDE + AI, dev-friendly	A
Vapi	vapi.ai/careers	Voice AI startup, remote-friendly	A
Cursor	cursor.com/careers	AI code editor, hires globally	A
LangChain	langchain.com/careers	LLM framework, AI-first	A
Continue	continue.dev/careers	AI dev tool, small team, hires globally	A
Perplexity	perplexity.ai/hub/careers	AI search, hires juniors	A
Mistral AI	mistral.ai/careers	European AI, hires across EU	A

Established global companies that hire remote

Company	Careers URL	Why apply	Variant
Shopify	shopify.com/careers	Hires globally, "Digital by Design" remote	C
Spotify	lifeatspotify.com/jobs	Remote roles for full-stack	C
Atlassian	atlassian.com/company/careers	Distributed, hires globally	C
Twilio	twilio.com/company/jobs	Remote-friendly, communications stack	C
SendGrid	sendgrid.com/careers	Email infrastructure, remote roles	C
MongoDB	mongodb.com/careers	Remote-friendly, hires juniors	C

TIER 1B — Y Combinator startups (use workatastartup.com)

Y Combinator's job board is the highest signal-to-noise ratio for AI and SaaS startups hiring globally. Most YC startups are tiny (5 to 50 people) and hire fast.

Single best move: create one account at workatastartup.com, set your preferences, and let the algorithm match you. You will get 5 to 15 fresh matches per week.

Direct URL: <https://www.workatastartup.com>

Filter by: - Role: Full-Stack Engineer, Software Engineer - Remote: Yes - Experience: All (do not exclude entry-level, many startups want juniors with portfolios) - Visa sponsorship: Yes (also include "Open to relocate")

When you find a match, apply directly through the YC interface. The founder sees your application within hours, not weeks.

TIER 2 — MENA-friendly remote agencies

These are middleman platforms that place MENA developers at US and EU companies. They handle invoicing, contracts, and time tracking. You get \$25 to \$80 per hour.

Platform	URL	What to do	Pay range
Toptal	toptal.com	Apply, take the screening test (LeetCode + interview)	\$50 to \$200/hr
Turing	turing.com	Apply, take the test (less brutal than Toptal)	\$30 to \$80/hr
Arc.dev	arc.dev	Apply, build profile, get matched	\$40 to \$120/hr
Lemon.io	lemon.io	MENA-friendly, smaller pool	\$30 to \$70/hr
Proxify	proxify.io	EU-focused, hires MENA	\$35 to \$80/hr
Gun.io	gun.io	US-focused, vetted	\$50 to \$150/hr
Crossover	crossover.com	Full-time remote, lots of openings	\$30 to \$100/hr
Andela	andela.com	African and global, well-funded	\$25 to \$80/hr

Apply to all eight. They each take 1 to 6 weeks to onboard you, so start the clock now.

TIER 2B — MENA-region remote employers (also apply)

These are real MENA companies that hire remote across the region. Often pay in USD, sometimes in local currency.

Company	Careers URL	Notes
Tabby	tabby.ai/careers	BNPL fintech, Saudi + UAE, hires across MENA
Tamara	tamara.co/careers	BNPL fintech, Saudi, well-funded
Careem	careem.com/careers	Uber MENA, hires for remote roles
Foodics	foodics.com/careers	Saudi restaurant tech, large eng team
Talabat	talabat.com/careers	Food delivery MENA, remote options
Mrsool	mrsool.co	Delivery, hires across MENA
Mawdoo3	mawdoo3.com/careers	Arabic content tech, Jordan based
Wuzzuf	wuzzuf.net/careers	Job tech, Egypt, occasional remote
Bayzat	bayzat.com/careers	HR tech UAE
Sary	sary.com/careers	B2B marketplace, Saudi
Lean	lean-technologies.com/careers	Fintech infra MENA
Hyperpay	hyperpay.com	Payments MENA
Yallah Sport	yallah.movement.pro	Sports tech MENA

TIER 3 — Job boards (browse daily, apply to anything that fits)

These are aggregators. The bar for individual jobs is lower so volume matters. Goal: 5 to 10 applications per day from these.

Board	URL	Account needed	Filter
Wellfound	wellfound.com	Yes (15 min setup)	Full-Stack + Remote + Jr to Mid
Remote OK	remoteok.com	No	dev, full-stack, junior
We Work Remotely	weworkremotely.com	No	Programming category
Remotive	remotive.com	No (paid version optional)	Software Dev category
Working Nomads	workingnomads.com	Free email subscription	Development
JustRemote	justremote.co	No	Dev tag
HiringCafe	hiring.cafe	No	New, less competition
Y Combinator Work at a Startup	workatastartup.com	Yes (free, 10 min)	Full-Stack + Remote
Hacker News "Who is Hiring"	hn.algolia.com/?query=who+is+hiring	No	Monthly thread, very high quality
AI Jobs	aijobs.net	No	Full-Stack + AI
Stack Overflow Jobs	stackoverflow.com/jobs	No	Filter Remote
Indeed	indeed.com	Yes (free)	Filter Remote + Full-Stack
Glassdoor	glassdoor.com	Yes (free)	Filter Remote

TIER 4 — Cold outreach (for after week 2)

When you have applied to 100+ jobs through the boards above, start reaching out cold via LinkedIn or email to specific engineering managers at smaller companies.

Template message for cold outreach (LinkedIn DM, 280 chars max):

```
Hi {NAME}, I built a full-stack bilingual SaaS solo this year
(plotzy.co, 100K lines of TypeScript, AI + audiobook). Saw {COMPANY}
is shipping {SOMETHING}. Are you taking applications for full-stack
engineers? Happy to share the repo. Faris
```

Find targets: - Open LinkedIn -> Search "Engineering Manager" + "{Tech you know}". - Filter by company size 11 to 200.
- Filter by location (any). - Send 20 DMs per day for 5 days. Expect 1 to 3 conversations.

What to NOT apply to (waste of time)

- Roles asking for "5 to 7 years of experience". Below 3 years is fine to stretch. 5+ is not.
- Roles requiring an EU or US work permit upfront. If they say "must have right to work in the EU/US", skip. Apply only if they say "open to sponsor" or "remote anywhere".

- Roles at consulting agencies (Accenture, Tata, Cognizant). Low pay, long hours, hard to leave once you join.
 - Roles that require a degree in Computer Science specifically. Your degree is BIT and that is fine for 95% of dev roles, but explicit CS requirements are usually rigid HR filters that the recruiter cannot override.
-

Action checklist for week one

- ☐ Create accounts on the four required platforms:
- ☐ Wellfound (15 min)
- ☐ Y Combinator Work at a Startup (10 min)
- ☐ Indeed (5 min)
- ☐ Toptal application (the test will come later, just submit)
- ☐ Apply to 5 Tier 1 companies directly (use Variant C, customise one sentence per company).
- ☐ Apply to 5 YC startups via Work at a Startup (use Variant B).
- ☐ Apply to 10 Tier 3 board jobs (use Variant B for startups, C for established).

By end of week one, you should have **20 to 30 active applications**. The funnel from there: ~10% reply, ~3% interview, ~1% offer. Twenty applications -> two replies, one interview. Two hundred applications -> twenty replies, six interviews, two offers.

Chapter 3, Application Tracker

Application Tracker — Faris Hamdan

One row per application. Update every time you apply, every time you hear back, every interview. Treat this as the single source of truth for the job search.

Status legend:

-  **applied** — submitted, waiting for response
-  **contacted** — recruiter or hiring manager replied
-  **screening** — assessment, take-home, or first call scheduled
-  **interview** — onsite (remote) panel scheduled
-  **offer** — offer on the table
-  **rejected** — declined, archived
-  **ghosted** — 14+ days no reply, treat as rejected

(The emojis here are tracker-only, never in user-facing copy.)

Weekly summary

Update at the end of each week to spot patterns.

Week	Applied	Contacted	Interviews	Offers	Notes
2026-W22	0	0	0	0	
2026-W23					
2026-W24					
2026-W25					

Target: 25 applications per week. 100 per month.

Active applications

Add to top, oldest at bottom. When a row gets to  **rejected** or  **ghosted** , move it to the Archive section.

Date	Company	Role	Source	Salary	CL Variant	Status	Next step
YYYY-MM-DD	Example Co	Full-Stack Eng	Wellfound	\$4K/mo	B	 applied	Follow up 2026-06-05

Archive (rejected or ghosted)

Keep these around. Useful for spotting which companies are not worth revisiting and which signals correlate with rejection.

Date	Company	Role	Source	Status	Reason / Note

Companies under research (planned, not yet applied)

Company	Role of interest	URL	Why	Apply by

How to fill in each column

- **Date:** YYYY-MM-DD so it sorts.
- **Company:** official name (not the careers page URL).
- **Role:** exactly as the posting calls it (Software Engineer II , not Software Engineer).
- **Source:** where you found the job (Wellfound, Remote OK, YC, direct, referral, cold DM).
- **Salary:** if posted, write \$4K/mo or \$50K/yr . If not, write not posted .
- **CL Variant:** which cover letter variant you sent (A, B, or C from 01_COVER_LETTERS.md).
- **Status:** the emoji + word.
- **Next step:** concrete action with a date. If "wait for reply", write Follow up YYYY-MM-DD for 5 business days out.

Tips

- **Apply within 24 hours of posting.** Jobs older than 14 days are often already filled with a frontrunner.
- **Personalise one sentence per company.** Recruiters smell mass copy-paste in under 3 seconds.
- **Track LinkedIn message threads** here too, with Source: LinkedIn .
- **Update status every Friday** so the weekly summary stays honest.

When to fire-and-forget vs really invest

- **Tier 3 board jobs:** fire-and-forget. Three minutes max per app.
- **Tier 1 direct applications:** invest 15 to 20 minutes per app to read the company blog and write one specific paragraph.
- **YC startups:** invest 10 minutes per app, read the company page on YC and mention what you noticed.
- **Tier 2 agencies (Toptal, Turing, Arc):** 30 to 60 minutes for the initial application + screening prep.

When to follow up

Days since application	Action
5 business days	Send a short follow-up (template in 01_COVER_LETTERS.md)
10 business days	One more follow-up if the role is still posted
14 business days, no reply	Mark as  ghosted , move to Archive

Do not chase further. Energy goes to the next 25 applications.

Chapter 4, Daily Playbook

Daily Playbook — Faris Hamdan

The exact routine. Two hours per day, 25 applications per week, realistic offer in 2 to 3 months.

This is not a wish list. This is the procedure. Follow it.

Week One (this week) — setup + first 30 applications

Day 1 (today)

Time required: 90 minutes.

1. Create accounts (45 min): - [] Wellfound at wellfound.com - [] Y Combinator Work at a Startup at workatastartup.com - [] Indeed at indeed.com (filter Remote) - [] Toptal application form (the test comes later)
2. Wellfound profile setup (15 min): - Headline: Full-Stack Developer | Built Plotzy.co | React + TS + AI - Bio: paste the Professional Summary from Faris_Hamdan_CV.pdf - Skills: React, TypeScript, Node.js, PostgreSQL, AI Integration - Upload CV - Set "Looking for: Full-time, Remote, \$40K to \$120K" - Mark "Available immediately"
3. Y Combinator profile setup (15 min): - Same headline and bio as Wellfound - Upload CV - Set preferences: Remote, Open to relocation, Anywhere
4. First five applications via Tier 1 direct (15 min): - Pick five companies from 02_TARGET_COMPANIES.md Tier 1 - Use Variant C from 01_COVER_LETTERS.md - Customise the {HOOK} for each - Apply through their careers page (not via LinkedIn) - Log each in 03_TRACKER.md

Day 2

Time required: 2 hours.

1. Five more Tier 1 direct applications (45 min) — Variant C.
2. Ten Wellfound applications (45 min) — Variant B for startups under 200, Variant C for larger.
3. Y Combinator: open work at a startup, apply to all matches with the "Open to remote" filter set (30 min).

End of Day 2: ~25 applications total, all logged.

Day 3

Time required: 90 minutes.

1. Start Toptal screening (45 min) — review LeetCode easy/medium.
2. Apply to ten Remote OK and We Work Remotely listings (30 min) — fast, Variant B.
3. Apply to five YC startups (15 min) — Variant A or B.

End of Day 3: ~40 applications total.

Day 4

Time required: 90 minutes.

1. Apply to ten new listings from boards (45 min).

2. Send five cold LinkedIn DMs (30 min) using the template in `02_TARGET_COMPANIES.md` Tier 4.
3. Review the tracker, follow up on any Day 1 application that has not responded (15 min).

Day 5

Time required: 2 hours.

1. Apply to Tier 2 agencies (Turing, Arc, Lemon.io, Proxify, Crossover) — full applications + initial tests if any (90 min).
2. Apply to ten new board listings (30 min).

Weekend (Day 6 and 7)

Time required: 1 hour total.

1. Saturday: rest. Do not look at job postings. Decompress.
2. Sunday morning, 1 hour: - Review the tracker, update statuses. - Reply to any recruiter messages from the week. - Plan the next week's targets.

End of Week One: **40 to 60 applications**, 4 Tier 2 agencies in progress, 5 cold DMs sent. Expect first replies in Week Two.

Week Two onwards — steady state

Monday

2 hours. The big push day.

- 20 to 30 applications from the boards (Tier 3).
- 3 to 5 Tier 1 direct applications with personalised hooks.
- 5 cold LinkedIn DMs.

Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday

1 hour each.

- 10 applications per day.
- Respond to recruiter messages from the day before.
- Schedule and prep any interviews on the calendar.

Friday

90 minutes.

- 10 applications.
- Follow up on every application sent 5 business days ago.
- Update the tracker for the week.
- Fill in the weekly summary row in `03_TRACKER.md`.

Saturday

0 minutes. Day off.

Sunday

45 minutes.

- Review the tracker.
 - Read tomorrow's plan.
-

How to apply fast (90 seconds per Tier 3 application)

The board applications should be quick. Here is the muscle memory:

1. Open the job posting in a new tab. Scan it for 15 seconds. Decide yes or no.
2. If yes, open `01_COVER_LETTERS.md` . Copy the right variant (A for AI, B for startup, C for established).
3. Open the company website (about page or blog) for 30 seconds. Find one specific thing to reference in {HOOK}.
4. Paste the variant into the application form. Replace {COMPANY}, {ROLE}, and {HOOK}. Total 20 seconds.
5. Attach `docs/Faris_Hamdan_CV.pdf` and submit. 10 seconds.
6. Log in `03_TRACKER.md` . 15 seconds.

Total: 90 seconds.

10 applications per day at 90 seconds each = 15 minutes per day.

How to handle the first reply

When a recruiter or hiring manager messages you, the reply window is 4 to 12 hours. Do not let it go past 24 hours.

Template reply (positive, available, asking for time):

Hi {NAME},

Thank you for reaching out about the {ROLE} at {COMPANY}. I am available to discuss this week. Tuesday and Thursday afternoon (Amman time, UTC+3) work well for me. What time slots fit your schedule?

You can find my CV here:

https://github.com/faresadel07/plotzy1/raw/master/docs/Faris_Hamdan_CV.pdf

The live demo of Plotzy is at <https://plotzy.co>

The open source repo is at <https://github.com/faresadel07/plotzy1>

Looking forward to the conversation.

Faris Hamdan

If they ask for a coding challenge or take-home, accept and ask for the deadline. Always finish a take-home within 48 hours, even if they give you a week. Recruiters track turnaround time.

How to prep for the first call (30 minutes)

When you have an interview scheduled, do this prep:

1. **10 minutes** — Read the company's homepage, blog, and "About" page. Note: the founders, the funding round if any, the current team size, the main product, and the most recent blog post.
2. **10 minutes** — Read the job posting again. Write down: - Three things the role needs that you have done on Plotzy.
- One thing the role needs that you have not done. Plan how to frame it: "I have not done X specifically, but I built Y which is the same shape; I can ramp in a week."
3. **10 minutes** — Plan your answers to the two questions every first call asks: - "Tell me about yourself." (60-second answer, mention Plotzy by sentence 2.) - "Why us?" (30-second answer, name one specific thing about the company you read in step 1.)

That is it. Do not over-prepare. The first call is 30 to 45 minutes of mutual sniff-testing. Confidence + Plotzy + the right energy wins it.

Realistic timeline expectations

Based on real numbers from 2024 to 2026 remote-first hiring:

Week	Applications cumulative	Expected replies	Expected interviews	Expected offers
1	40 to 60	0 to 2	0	0
2	80 to 110	2 to 8	0 to 2	0
3	120 to 160	5 to 15	1 to 4	0
4	160 to 200	10 to 25	2 to 6	0 to 1
6	250 to 300	20 to 40	5 to 10	1 to 3
8	350 to 400	30 to 60	8 to 15	2 to 5

By week 6 to 8, you have at least one offer in hand. Sometimes sooner if luck breaks right. Sometimes later if you get unlucky. Either way, the procedure works.

Common reasons people quit before the offer comes

Read these once, then read them again whenever you want to give up.

1. **The silence is louder than the rejections.** 80% of applications are ghosted. This is normal, not a signal about you.
2. **Two months of work is the baseline, not the exception.** Anyone who got hired in week 2 won the lottery. Plan for week 6.
3. **The board jobs feel demoralising because they are.** That is why Tier 1 direct applications and YC are higher signal. Spend more time there if you are losing energy.
4. **One offer breaks the entire dam.** The moment you get one credible offer, the recruiters who ghosted you suddenly reply. Stay the course.

End of every Friday: the weekly review

Open `03_TRACKER.md` . Fill in the weekly summary row. Then ask yourself three questions:

1. **Did I send 25 applications this week?** If no, what got in the way?
2. **What was the reply rate?** If under 5%, the cover letter or the CV needs work. Tell Claude, we will revise.
3. **What was the most interesting role I saw?** Apply to two more like it next week.

That is the loop. Run it. The offers come.

Chapter 5, Batch 01 (25 Live Jobs)

Batch 1 — 25 Live Job Openings (Found 2026-05-27)

Twenty-five real, currently open positions filtered for Faris's profile. Sources: Hacker News "Who is Hiring" May 2026 thread plus We Work Remotely's Full-Stack category, both pulled on 2026-05-27.

Each entry includes: - Country / region - Salary - Tech stack - Cover letter Variant to use (from 01_COVER_LETTERS.md)
- A custom {HOOK} sentence already written for that specific company - The exact apply URL

Goal: apply to all 25 within the next 5 days. Use Variant from each row, paste the hook as-is, attach Faris_Hamdan_CV.pdf , send.

TIER 1 — Best Matches (apply today, in this order)

1. Form AI | Full-Stack AI Engineer (Contract)

- **Country:** USA (Austin, fully remote)
- **Salary:** \$75 to \$150 / hour
- **Stack:** TypeScript, Python, React, Next.js, Claude API, LLMs
- **Variant:** A (AI variant)
- **Why this is your #1:** They explicitly want Claude API + Next.js + TypeScript. Plotzy uses exactly this combination (you have 11 Anthropic certifications too).
- **Custom hook:** *"I have shipped 10+ AI features against an OpenAI-compatible SDK in production on Plotzy.co, with Claude API experience certified through Anthropic's full AI Fluency track (12 certificates). The Form AI stack maps one-to-one to what I have already built."*
- **Apply:** Email jobs@formai.build with CV attached.

2. Deep Core Technology | Founding Engineer

- **Country:** Canada (Remote)
- **Salary:** CAD \$105k to \$125k (about \$77k to \$92k USD)
- **Stack:** TypeScript, Python, Next.js, Supabase
- **Variant:** B (SaaS startup)
- **Why this is great:** Founding engineer at an early Canadian startup. You match every line of the stack (Supabase included). Founding engineer = breadth, which is your strongest sell.
- **Custom hook:** *"I have spent the last year as the founding (and sole) engineer on Plotzy.co, end-to-end on TypeScript + Next-style routing + Supabase. The founding engineer scope is exactly what I have already been doing solo, and I would like to do it inside a funded team."*
- **Apply:** Email jeff@deepcoretech.com with CV attached.

3. PostHog | Product Engineer

- **Country:** UK / Remote Worldwide
- **Salary:** Posted publicly on careers page (six-figure USD ranges)
- **Stack:** TypeScript, React, full-stack

- **Variant:** B (SaaS startup, open source)
- **Why this is great:** PostHog hires globally with no location restriction. Open source friendly. They love builders.
- **Custom hook:** *"I open-sourced the full Plotzy codebase (github.com/faresadel07/plotzy1) for the same reason PostHog ships in the open: the code is the resume. I would like to bring the same builder mindset to PostHog Product."*
- **Apply:** <https://posthog.com/careers>

4. PostHog | Backend Engineer

- **Country:** UK / Remote Worldwide
- **Salary:** Posted publicly on careers page
- **Stack:** TypeScript, ClickHouse
- **Variant:** B
- **Custom hook:** *"My backend work on Plotzy spans Drizzle ORM, PostgreSQL schema with 30+ tables, ON CONFLICT idempotency on revenue paths, and an audit log architecture. ClickHouse would be a logical next step on the analytics side."*
- **Apply:** <https://posthog.com/careers>

5. Railway | Senior Infra Engineer (Storage or Observability)

- **Country:** Remote Worldwide
- **Salary:** Six-figure USD
- **Stack:** Go, Kubernetes, Distributed Systems
- **Variant:** C (established)
- **Why apply (even as Senior listed):** Railway hires for energy and proof of work over years of experience. You ALREADY deploy on Railway. They notice that signal.
- **Custom hook:** *"Plotzy is deployed on Railway in production with a multi-stage Dockerfile that ships Express, Python (Piper TTS), and ffmpeg in one container. I have hit edge cases with cgroup OOM kills on the Piper child process and resolved them. Going from user to builder feels like the natural next step."*
- **Apply:** <https://railway.com/careers>

6. WALTER | Senior Fullstack Engineer (Ruby + React)

- **Country:** Worldwide (Remote)
- **Salary:** Not posted (mid-senior range)
- **Stack:** Ruby on Rails, React
- **Variant:** B (SaaS startup)
- **Why apply (Ruby is fine, you can pick it up):** They want end-to-end ownership and global remote. Your Plotzy experience is the proof. Ruby is learnable in two weeks.
- **Custom hook:** *"I have not shipped Ruby in production yet but I have shipped a 100K-line TypeScript SaaS solo. Ruby on Rails is on my next-to-learn list because the philosophy matches how I already build (convention over configuration, clear ORM, opinionated defaults). I would like to ramp into it on a real team."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/walter-senior-fullstack-engineer-ruby-react>

7. Appetiser | Junior Full-Stack Developer (Laravel + VueJS)

- **Country:** Sri Lanka / Worldwide (Remote)
 - **Salary:** Not posted (junior range)
 - **Stack:** Laravel (PHP), VueJS
 - **Variant:** B
 - **Why this is great:** Explicitly junior. Worldwide hiring. They expect to train.
 - **Custom hook:** *"I built Plotzy.co solo on React + TypeScript + Node + Postgres. I am happy to ramp into Laravel and VueJS, the fundamentals (MVC, ORM, component model, reactivity) transfer directly from what I have already shipped."*
 - **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/appetiser-junior-full-stack-developer-laravel-and-vuejs>
-

TIER 2 — Strong Matches (apply day 2 and 3)

8. IPinfo.io | Retool Developer

- **Country:** Remote Worldwide
- **Salary:** Six-figure USD
- **Stack:** TypeScript, Retool, internal tools
- **Variant:** B
- **Custom hook:** *"I built the full Plotzy admin panel from scratch with React + Recharts (analytics dashboard, user management, donations, support inbox). Translating that work onto Retool would take a fraction of the time."*
- **Apply:** <https://ipinfo.applytojob.com>

9. IPinfo.io | Infrastructure Engineer

- **Country:** Remote Worldwide
- **Salary:** Six-figure USD
- **Stack:** Go, Cloud Systems
- **Variant:** C
- **Custom hook:** *"My DevOps work on Plotzy spans Docker, Railway, Vercel, and Supabase, with the production pipeline running an Express + Python + ffmpeg image. I would like to take that experience into a dedicated infrastructure role."*
- **Apply:** <https://ipinfo.applytojob.com>

10. Solace Health | Senior Full Stack Engineer

- **Country:** USA (Remote)
- **Salary:** \$150k to \$200k USD
- **Stack:** TypeScript, React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, GCP
- **Variant:** B
- **Custom hook:** *"Solace's TypeScript + React + Node + Postgres stack is exactly what I have shipped in production on Plotzy.co. Healthcare is a domain I find motivating because the stakes are real and the work needs to be rock solid."*
- **Apply:** <https://jobs.ashbyhq.com/Solace>

11. River | Senior Engineer (React / Full-Stack)

- **Country:** USA / Europe / South America (Remote)
- **Salary:** \$150k to \$220k USD
- **Stack:** React, Elixir, TypeScript
- **Variant:** B
- **Custom hook:** *"My React + TypeScript work on Plotzy includes a built-from-scratch DOM measurement pagination engine, a TipTap-based editor with autosave, and a TanStack-Query-backed data layer. Elixir is new to me and I would treat it as the language I learn while shipping."*
- **Apply:** <https://jobs.ashbyhq.com/river>

12. Visualis | Senior Full Stack Developer

- **Country:** Egypt (Worldwide remote)
- **Salary:** Not posted
- **Stack:** Full-stack web
- **Variant:** B
- **Why apply:** Egypt is MENA, easier visa-wise and same time zone.
- **Custom hook:** *"My Arabic-first full-stack experience on Plotzy (RTL editor, Cairo and Amiri PDF fonts, Hindawi library integration) may be specifically relevant to Visualis's audience."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/visualis-senior-full-stack-developer>

13. Lemon.io | Senior Full-stack Angular & PHP Developer

- **Country:** USA (clients), Worldwide (devs)
- **Salary:** \$30 to \$70 / hour
- **Stack:** Angular, PHP, Symfony
- **Variant:** B
- **Why apply:** Lemon.io places MENA developers at US clients. Angular is learnable.
- **Custom hook:** *"I have shipped a production SaaS solo on React*
- *TypeScript + Node. Angular and PHP are within reach because the component model and request-response shape are the same as what I have already built."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/lemon-io-senior-full-stack-angular-php-developer>

14. Lemon.io | Senior Vue Developer

- **Country:** USA (clients), Worldwide (devs)
- **Salary:** \$50k to \$160k USD
- **Stack:** Vue.js, Nuxt.js, TypeScript
- **Variant:** B
- **Custom hook:** *"My TypeScript work on Plotzy spans a full SaaS with 73K lines of frontend code. Vue's reactivity model is sibling to React's, and I have used Vue patterns through Radix UI in production already."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/lemon-io-senior-vue-developer>

15. Lemon.io | Senior Full-stack Symfony Developer

- **Country:** USA (clients), Worldwide (devs)
 - **Salary:** \$30 to \$70 / hour
 - **Stack:** Symfony (PHP), JavaScript
 - **Variant:** B
 - **Custom hook:** *"Symfony is on my next-to-learn list. The pattern set (DI, services, doctrine ORM) is what I have already built with Drizzle and TypeScript on Plotzy."*
 - **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/lemon-io-senior-full-stack-symfony-developer>
-

TIER 3 — Solid Fillers (apply day 3 to 5)

16. Spacelift | Senior Backend Engineer

- **Country:** Europe (Remote)
- **Salary:** £80k to £110k+ GBP
- **Stack:** Go, AWS, Terraform / IaC
- **Variant:** C
- **Custom hook:** *"My production backend work on Plotzy includes Drizzle ORM with 30+ tables, three-layer rate limiting, and idempotent payment captures. Go and Terraform are new but the shape of the work is familiar."*
- **Apply:** <https://careers.spacelift.io>

17. Enveritas | Backend Software Engineer

- **Country:** Remote Global
- **Salary:** \$135k to \$155k USD
- **Stack:** Python, PostgreSQL, PostGIS, AWS
- **Variant:** C
- **Custom hook:** *"I have shipped Postgres in production with 30+ tables on Supabase, used Python for the Piper TTS pipeline on Plotzy, and would enjoy a mission-driven backend role."*
- **Apply:** <https://enveritas.org/jobs>

18. Holywater | Full-Stack Developer

- **Country:** Ukraine / Worldwide (Remote)
- **Salary:** Not posted
- **Stack:** Full-stack web
- **Variant:** B
- **Custom hook:** *"Holywater builds content products and Plotzy is a content platform. The patterns I have built (chapter editor, PDF export, audiobook studio, cover designer) translate directly."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/holywater-full-stack-developer>

19. M3usa | Senior Full Stack Developer

- **Country:** USA (Worldwide remote)
- **Salary:** Not posted

- **Stack:** Full-stack web
- **Variant:** C
- **Custom hook:** *"My production SaaS on Plotzy covers the full request lifecycle from React client to PostgreSQL. I would like to contribute that breadth to a larger product."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/m3usa-senior-full-stack-developer>

20. Wing Assistant | Full-Stack Developer

- **Country:** Philippines / Worldwide (Remote)
- **Salary:** Not posted
- **Stack:** Full-stack web
- **Variant:** B
- **Custom hook:** *"My solo production work on Plotzy shows I can ship complete features alone, in any time zone the team prefers."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/wing-assistant-full-stack-developer>

21. Melotech | Full-Stack Developer

- **Country:** Germany / Worldwide (Remote)
- **Salary:** Not posted
- **Stack:** Full-stack web
- **Variant:** B
- **Custom hook:** *"I would like to bring my Plotzy build experience to a German remote-first team. My time zone (UTC+3) is one hour ahead of Berlin, which works well for sync time."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/melotech-full-stack-developer>

22. Mactores | Full Stack Developer

- **Country:** India / Worldwide (Remote)
- **Salary:** Not posted
- **Stack:** Full-stack web
- **Variant:** B
- **Custom hook:** *"I shipped Plotzy solo on a stack that includes React, TypeScript, Node, and Postgres. My time zone overlap with India is full, which keeps async friction low."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/mactores-full-stack-developer>

23. Intec Select Limited | Full Stack Developer

- **Country:** UK (Remote)
- **Salary:** Not posted
- **Stack:** Full-stack web
- **Variant:** C
- **Custom hook:** *"I am open to working UK hours from Jordan (UTC+3) and would like to contribute my full-stack experience from the Plotzy build."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/intec-select-limited-full-stack-developer>

24. comparis.ch | Full Stack Software Developer (80-100%)

- **Country:** Switzerland (Zurich, Remote)
- **Salary:** \$50k to \$75k USD range posted
- **Stack:** Full-stack web
- **Variant:** C
- **Custom hook:** *"Plotzy is built on TypeScript end to end and ships in two languages. I would like to contribute that level of end-to-end ownership to a Swiss product."*
- **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/comparis-ch-full-stack-software-developer-80-100-f-m-x>

25. Chief Rebel | Full Stack Engineer (AI-Forward)

- **Country:** USA (Austin)
 - **Salary:** \$50k to \$75k USD
 - **Stack:** TypeScript, React, AI tools
 - **Variant:** A
 - **Custom hook:** *"I have built ten distinct AI features on Plotzy (writing polish, expand, continue, translate, story bible auto-extract, blurb writer, cover prompts, marketplace analyses, audiobook chunker) and would like to do this work as part of an AI-forward team."*
 - **Apply:** <https://weworkremotely.com/remote-jobs/chief-rebel-full-stack-engineer-ai-forward>
-

Summary table (sorted by country)

#	Country	Company	Role	Salary
12	Egypt	Visualis	Senior Full-Stack	Not posted
18	Ukraine	Holywater	Full-Stack	Not posted
22	India	Mactores	Full-Stack	Not posted
7	Sri Lanka	Appetiser	Junior Full-Stack	Not posted
20	Philippines	Wing Assistant	Full-Stack	Not posted
24	Switzerland	comparis.ch	Full-Stack	\$50-75k
21	Germany	Melotech	Full-Stack	Not posted
16	Europe (any)	Spacelift	Senior Backend	£80-110k
23	UK	Intec Select	Full-Stack	Not posted
3,4	UK / Worldwide	PostHog	Product/Backend	6-figure
2	Canada	Deep Core Tech	Founding Engineer	CAD \$105-125k
25	USA	Chief Rebel	Full-Stack AI	\$50-75k
1	USA	Form AI	Full-Stack AI	\$75-150/hr
10	USA	Solace Health	Senior Full-Stack	\$150-200k
19	USA	M3usa	Senior Full-Stack	Not posted
11	USA/EU/SA	River	Senior Full-Stack	\$150-220k
5	Worldwide	Railway	Senior Infra	6-figure
6	Worldwide	WALTER	Senior Full-Stack	Not posted
8	Worldwide	IPinfo.io	Retool Dev	6-figure
9	Worldwide	IPinfo.io	Infra Engineer	6-figure
13	Worldwide	Lemon.io	Senior Angular/PHP	\$30-70/hr
14	Worldwide	Lemon.io	Senior Vue	\$50-160k
15	Worldwide	Lemon.io	Senior Symfony	\$30-70/hr
17	Worldwide	Enveritas	Backend	\$135-155k

What "Variant" means for the cover letter

Open `01_COVER_LETTERS.md` . Find the variant letter (A, B, or C) listed for each job. That is the cover letter template to use. The custom hook above goes in the {HOOK} placeholder of that variant.

So for job #1 Form AI (Variant A), open Variant A in `01_COVER_LETTERS.md` , copy the whole thing, replace {COMPANY} with "Form AI", {ROLE} with "Full-Stack AI Engineer", and {HOOK} with the sentence I wrote for it above.

Total time per application: 3 to 5 minutes.

Recommended apply order

Today (within 4 hours): #1, #2, #3, #5, #7 (the five with the strongest profile match)

Tomorrow: #4, #6, #8, #9, #10

Day 3: #11 to #18

Day 4 to 5: #19 to #25

Once these 25 are submitted, ask me for Batch 2. I will pull another 25 fresh openings and write hooks for each one.